STATUS REPORT

Libya — digital transformation and data governance status report

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ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Libya ranks first of 54 African states for mobile communications, at 91.9 out of 100 in 2023 after a 60.7-point rise over the decade, and yet it has no operating internet exchange point: LYB-IX is registered to the Libyan International Telecommunication Company and carries no connected peers (2026). International capacity now runs through the Medusa submarine cable, inaugurated at Misrata in May 2025 on an 8,700 km route around the Mediterranean, with further landings at Tripoli and Benghazi still only planned at that point. Root name servers came online in Tripoli and Benghazi in October 2025, and Almadar Aljadid opened the first 5G network in central Tripoli in January 2026 over part of one city. The move from IPv4 to IPv6 has not been made, and the regulator convened operators in April 2026 to activate it.

4G reached 83.7% of the population in 2025, against around 40% in 2021, and more than four-fifths of Libyans used the internet in 2024. Mobile connections run at close to twice the population (2025), which is multi-SIM ownership rather than individual reach, and a mobile broadband plan still costs more than the UN Broadband Commission's affordability target (2021). Infrastructure is concentrated in the cities, with rural connectivity limited and unreliable (2025), and where it reaches it runs on single routes: floods severed the fibre between Ghat and Tahala on 27 May 2026, and 11 of the 12 affected sites were back within three days, most of them over VSAT satellite backup rather than by repair of the cable.

The build is state-led through the Libyan Post, Telecommunications and Information Technology Company, whose subsidiaries include Almadar Aljadid. Licensing is where the two administrations collide. Law No. 22 of 2010 reserves the issue of telecommunications licences to the Tripoli-based General Authority for Telecommunications and Informatics, which invoked it in August 2025 to suspend Huawei's activities for three days before agreeing terms on which they could continue; the House of Representatives-appointed government's communications ministry issued a unified national telecoms licence under the same statute, effective 4 March 2025.

Data Storage

Libya's government data has no national home to go to. The National Cloud Computing Policy that would govern where it is hosted was only proposed in January 2026, developed with UN-ESCWA, and the national government data centre and disaster-recovery centre called for by the April 2025 digital transformation strategy have not been built; there is no shared cloud platform available across government (2025). Commercially there is no hyperscale capacity, and the facilities listed in Tripoli, Benghazi and elsewhere are small (2024).

The last publicly announced attempt at a domestic private-cloud facility dates to October 2019, when Trans-Sahara and the state-owned Tatweer Research announced a containerised data centre for deployment in Tripoli to serve government agencies and local companies, with PCI DSS certification sought so that the financial sector could use it. Its data-centre unit manager named political unrest, electricity instability and infrastructure as the obstacles to running one in Libya.

The one rule on where data may sit is sectoral. The Central Bank's personal data protection regulation bars the banks, fintechs and payment providers it supervises from holding personal, financial, credit or sensitive data outside Libya, and becomes mandatory on 1 July 2026.

Energy

The General Electricity Company of Libya warned in August 2025 of near-total grid collapse, after a complete regional outage in the east in May 2025 and against a background of extended daily load-shedding, gas feedstock shortages, ageing and damaged plant and deliberate disruption of gas supply. Electricity reached 73.2% of the population in 2023, up from 70.0% in 2022, low for a state whose revenue comes from hydrocarbons, and access to energy scored 68.9 out of 100 in 2023, 11th of 54 African states but down 5.5 points since 2014. Urban Libya is close to universally connected; rural Libya is far behind it.

There is little behind the grid to steady it: renewables account for about 3% of total final energy consumption (2021), and there is no utility-scale grid-connected renewable capacity. The Renewable Energy Authority launched a National Strategy for Renewable Energy and Energy Efficiency 2023-2035 with USAID support in December 2023, alongside a 'Go Green' initiative targeting 500MW of distributed rooftop photovoltaic capacity. Power meanwhile stays close to free at the point of use, under one of the world's heaviest energy subsidy regimes (2023).

What this costs the digital economy shows in both directions. A data-centre operator named electricity instability among the reasons one is hard to run in Libya (2019), and the Central Bank raised cash withdrawal ceilings in August 2026, attributing the move to repeated power cuts and fuel shortages disrupting some regions — the grid pushing users back towards notes in the same plan that makes electronic payment one of its four pillars.

Technical Capacity

Libya has a digital transformation strategy and no part of government leading its delivery: no ministry or department owns public-sector digital transformation, there is no cross-government forum in which senior digital officials can address digital, data, technology and capacity questions, and nothing is published on progress or spending (2025). A government entity focused on GovTech does exist, but no steering committee or council leads GovTech initiatives, no body monitors digital spending across government, and the institution publishes no annual progress report (2025). Nor is there any government strategy or programme to raise digital skills in the public sector (2025), and public administration is one of the three governance areas in which Libya scores worst in Africa (2023).

Where the state does build, it buys. The first e-passport programme went to an overseas vendor and was deployed from 2021 for diplomatic and special passports, the ordinary biometric passport for the general public still pending (2025), and the Central Bank reached for international specialist support to investigate its June 2026 cyber incident.

The shortfall shows in the systems already running. The electronic payment system collapsed under record load in May 2026; adoption of e-management inside the Ministry of Interior remains early, held back by weak digital infrastructure and a shortage of specialised staff (2023); and the cadastre still rests on incomplete aerial photogrammetry with no modern GIS or spatial database behind it, survey activity having been suspended after 2011 (2024).

Cybersecurity

The Central Bank of Libya disclosed in June 2026 that it had detected a cyber incident affecting some of its technical systems and services, isolating the systems suspected of being affected and running the investigation with international specialist firms. No law would have obliged it to say anything: nothing in Libyan law requires an organisation to notify users, a regulator or any authority of a breach within a set time, the 2022 electronic transactions and cybercrime laws stopping at confidentiality duties and penalties (2024).

The body overseeing cybersecurity is not a regulator in the ordinary sense: the National Information Security and Safety Authority, created by Decree No. 28 of 2013, accredits electronic authentication providers, but its personal-data policies bind only public-sector bodies and it cannot take complaints or enforce data protection rules (2024). A comprehensive law is still in preparation, on the eastern track: a House of Representatives committee met the National Security Council in Benghazi in July 2026 to draw one up, none enacted at that date. What is on the books is Law No. 5 of 2022 on Combating Cybercrimes, which gives digital identity standing as a legal concept and criminalises unauthorised use of another person's digital identification tools, and the National Guide for Government Data Governance, which names cybersecurity-by-design a foundational pillar and sets digital identity as the reference point for verification and trust across government systems.

ITU's Global Cybersecurity Index put that declared commitment at 68.09 out of 100 in 2024, in its advancing band. The estate has been tested harder. A record 2 million point-of-sale transactions across 67,000 points in a single day in May 2026 collapsed the electronic payment system, and the Central Bank apologised; it answered in June 2026 with a National Stand-In Processing Service meant to keep payments running through communications or banking disruption. The House of Representatives Defence and National Security Committee warned in December 2025 of manipulation inside the Civil Registry Authority that had let foreign nationals obtain National ID Numbers unlawfully, and the GNU Interior Ministry's cybercrime work in early 2025 ran to social media cases and device seizures.

DPI

Data Exchange

Libya's data exchange is a rule without a network: the National Guide for Government Data Governance requires government bodies to integrate through the National Data Exchange (LY-NDEX) and adopts the once-only principle, under which a citizen gives the state a piece of information once, while the government interoperability framework that would make either work exists only in draft or planned form, with no data quality framework and nothing monitoring the uptime of government information systems.

The platform that does join institutions is a reporting one. LY-GOVREP has been in preliminary operation since July 2025 and connects 60 government entities for reports and inspection rather than for interoperability, and it reaches central government only, coordination below that level being especially hard across two administrations.

None of the government management information systems Libya has in use exchanges data with any other.

The direction is set on paper. The General Information Authority published an interoperability roadmap with UN-ESCWA in December 2025 proposing a four-phase build of a Libyan Government Interoperability Framework, a proposed action plan rather than an adopted framework with binding milestones, and no legislation yet establishes the authority to share data across government at all.

So integration is negotiated body by body. The Authority pressed the Libyan Zakat Fund to connect its platforms to LY-NDEX at a Tripoli workshop on 23 April 2026 and agreed with the Union of Chambers of Commerce that month to build an electronic Chambers system designed to interoperate with it; a national workshop convened by the Ministry of Interior closed on 8 July 2026 with the Central Bank of Libya, the Financial Intelligence Unit, the Tax Authority, Customs, the Civil Status Authority and the Commercial Registry Authority working through the procedural barriers to sharing data among themselves. The Unified Economic Number is likewise to be implemented by linking databases across ministries, agencies and public institutions, with no architecture, standard or platform named.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Libya's Attorney General found in January 2026 that 61 family records had been irregularly transferred between civil-registry offices without ever existing in the Civil Registry Authority database, producing National ID Numbers and Libyan passports for 225 foreign nationals. The register is held centrally while issuance of the numbers is devolved to local offices, the design that let those records pass between offices without appearing at the centre. At Al-Marj in the east a foreign national was jailed, a family record suspended and ten numbers cancelled in the same month.

The number carries the whole administrative state. Law No. 8 of 2014 makes the 13-digit National ID Number the statutory means of identifying a person before every state institution: it is granted at birth from Civil Registry data, and salaries are suspended for citizens who fail to supply it. It gates a bank account, a SIM card, the main social assistance grants and the vote, checked on paper rather than against the database in real time, and it is reserved by law for citizens, so non-nationals, refugees and stateless residents cannot be enrolled.

Civil registration is the country's strongest administrative function, scoring 75.0 out of 100 in 2023 and seventh of 54 African states, resting on a single automated Civil Registration Authority database linking 12 branches, 133 issuing offices and 400 service offices, with near-complete birth registration. The Intilaqa project had reconciled electronic against paper records for 97% of 1.8 million families by September 2024. The most recent nationwide figure for how many Libyans hold a number dates from 2013.

LY-DNID is being rolled out in three levels: the first, for government-to-government exchange, is in use across public institutions; the second, verification for citizens, entered pilot trials in November 2025; the third, biometric, is in technical trials. The biometric trials run with the Central Bank of Libya, the anti-money-laundering authority and participating banks, and have not entered operational use for know-your-customer checks. Meanwhile the 2014 law requires ten fingerprints, an iris scan, a photograph and a signature for every citizen though the card in circulation carries no chip.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Electronic transactions in Libya reached LD 643 billion between 1 January and 31 July 2026, and the Central Bank of Libya expects the year to pass a trillion dinars. Between 1 January and 31 July 2026 LYPay and OnePay instant payments carried LD 252 billion, mobile banking apps LD 209 billion, RTGS LD 143 billion and cards at point of sale LD 33 billion across more than 270,000 terminals, while e-wallets carried LD 650 million.

The growth is a symptom as much as an achievement. Banks still cannot meet large cash withdrawals despite newly printed notes being imported, and merchants' own suppliers discount for cash, so some clinics and medical centres add a surcharge for paying by card, making a displayed price two prices. A record day of point-of-sale traffic in May 2026 brought the payment system down altogether.

The rails are the central bank's own. It operates LYPay and OnePay, live since 1 August 2024, publishes the scheme's technical documentation, API specifications and compliance guidance openly, and carries person-to-person, person-to-merchant and merchant-to-merchant transfers on it, so business payments run over the same national rails as retail ones. Banks were directed to activate QR payment at point of sale by 8 March 2026, SoftPOS, which turns an NFC phone into a terminal, was launched in June 2026 alongside international Visa acceptance in foreign currency and a stand-in processing service meant to keep payments running through communications or banking disruption.

Underneath, access to banking scored 8.4 out of 100 in 2023, 44th of 54 African states, and has fallen slightly over the decade. Wallets are rationed by nationality: citizens may send up to LD 100,000 person-to-person and LD 2 million business-to-business a day, resident foreigners LD 50,000 and LD 100,000, and legal residency is itself the gate, since the wallet opened to foreigners from March 2026 is issued on a passport and residency card. Collection has followed: Decision No. 247 of 2024 added electronic collection of income tax from 15 May 2024, and later decrees require the treasuries of all ministries and public bodies to accept electronic payment of taxes, customs duties and other dues.

Registries

Decision No. 348, issued on 17 July 2026, authorises Libya's Ministry of Economy and Trade to begin implementing a Unified Economic Number as a single identifier for every economic, commercial and investment entity registered in the country, with a National Council chaired by the minister setting its standards; no timetable, budget, vendor or legal basis for the linkage behind it is stated, and no data protection role is named.

The registers it would join are in poor repair. The cadastre still rests on incomplete aerial photogrammetry covering around two-thirds of the country, with no modern GIS or spatial database behind it, survey having been suspended after 2011; the Real Estate Registration Authority was shut for a decade and only partially reactivated in 2022, leaving new ownership registrations unprocessed, and issued its first electronic certificate in April 2025. Company registration remains a counter transaction, run separately by the Tripoli and Benghazi authorities, though its one-stop shop began reactivating in February 2026. Addressing is the exception: Libya Post's national system has issued over 762,580 standardised addresses, and a June 2026 project would give every registered company an address tied to its physical location, joining the two registers at the planning stage.

Social and labour registers sit apart. A Unified Social Registry was approved in draft in June 2025 to bring social and economic data from across assistance programmes into one periodically updated database; it remains under development; an evaluation found no working data-sharing arrangement between the Ministry of Social Affairs and the Social Security Fund, with agency-specific registers including a disability registry held separately, while the principal cash transfer verifies beneficiaries against the Civil Status Authority's identity database. The interior and labour ministries agreed on 3 August 2026 to build a unified national database and electronic platform for expatriate labour, designed around inspection and enforcement of the labour market rather than around service to the people recorded in it.

The electoral register has stood at about 2.87 million since the 2021 drive and was confirmed unchanged in October 2022, and biometric verification of voters has been introduced in municipal council elections.

Sectoral management information systems

About 1.7 million public-sector employees — 76% of the workforce — were enrolled in the Ratibak Lahzi salary system at the July 2026 salary release, though the Central Bank was still working with the Ministry of Finance that month to automate complaint intake and the handling of unexecuted salaries.

Roughly half a million public-sector employees remained outside that system in July 2026.

Behind the payroll, the core financial machinery is unbuilt. The Financial Management Information System is under implementation and not yet operational, as is the Treasury Single Account it is meant to support, with no interface to Central Bank systems and no governance arrangements for treasury operations. There is no unified budget classification or chart of accounts, no debt management system and no human resources management information system and no payroll system linked to one. Libya scores 0.0 for tax and revenue mobilisation and 8.3 for budgetary and financial management, last of 54 African states on both.

What does run, runs alone. A customs management information system is in use on off-the-shelf software, with customs and tax administration unmerged and no governance arrangements covering compliance, security or audit trails; a public investment management system publishes no project database and no results; a social insurance and pension system covering public sector pensions does not use the national identification number even as a secondary identifier; and the Tax Authority launched a Unified Tax System in December 2025 with no published figure for how many taxpayers sit on it.

Health and education run reporting layers over paper. Medical records in primary healthcare clinics remain paper-based, health management information systems are not in routine use nationally or locally, and the absence of interoperable electronic health records is a critical weakness; DHIS2 is being expanded with WHO support but health data systems remain internal to the sector; the Education Management Information System collects school statistics and learner records go into no government-wide exchange, while rural primary schools keep student, attendance and staff records on paper. The Attorney General's Office has digitised 400,000 case archives and runs its own prosecution system, self-contained like the rest.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Libya's online public service portal is informational only: a resident cannot register a business through it, there is no government mobile app for public services, no involvement of citizens or businesses in designing what it does and no publication of how it performs. There is no government job portal and no online social insurance or pension service, and no platform through which citizens can give feedback on public service delivery, no published service standards and no record of any government response.

Traders have done better than citizens. Visa issuance moved fully online through the Wafed and E-Visa systems, which became fully operational by June 2026, replaced every previous channel and had issued about 6,000 e-visas. The Unified Export Window processed LD 79.5 million of exports in its first four months to July 2026, with 354 companies registered on it and 190 distinct products shipped to more than 20 destinations, though Tunisia took 129 of the orders and Turkey 28, and nothing has been published for what the paper process handled before, so the platform's effect on exports cannot be read off it. The Port Trade Service for vessel-arrival notifications and cargo manifests has been live at Tripoli and Al-Khoms through the Ministry of Economy and Trade's Libya Trade Net since 5 August 2026, with no volumes, fees or platform documentation published.

Revenue services are half-built: the Tax Authority's portal at ly.tax offers digital registration for individuals and companies with payment completed online, but there is no electronic invoicing, and the e-procurement portal is still under implementation, publishes nothing to the Open Contracting Data Standard and has no governance arrangements covering registers, security or audit trails.

The gap is one of ownership rather than ambition. A government entity focused on GovTech exists, but there is no coordination body leading initiatives, nothing monitoring digital spending across government and no published annual progress report, and no ministry or department leads digital transformation across the public sector. The Ministry of Civil Service was scoping its own modernisation and e-services with Huawei Libya in July 2026, with no agreement and no value announced.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

A House of Representatives committee met the National Security Council in Benghazi in July 2026 to prepare a comprehensive cybersecurity law, which had not been enacted at that date; the committee was created by Speaker's decision 115/2025 and is chaired by MP Asma al-Khoja.

The binding digital law Libya does have is two statutes from 2022. Law No. 5 of 2022 on Combating Cybercrimes gives "digital identity" and "identification and identity tools" standing as legal concepts and criminalises the unauthorised seizure or use of another person's digital identification tools. Law No. 6 of 2022 on Electronic Transactions provides the legal basis for electronic authentication, regulating the certificates and signature tools issued by accredited providers. Neither is a data-protection statute, and Libya has none.

Telecommunications runs on one statute that both capitals read as their own. The General Authority for Telecommunications and Informatics in Tripoli holds that Law No. 22 of 2010 vests the power to issue telecommunications licences and permits in it alone, and invoked it in August 2025 when it suspended Huawei's activities; the House of Representatives-appointed government's Ministry of Communications and Informatics has licensed a national telecoms operator under the same law.

Where the state now wants data to move, the statute book is silent. The General Information Authority's own national interoperability plan records that the enabling legislation for a data exchange system is still under development, with a data-governance guide and an open-data policy also in draft (February 2026). The expatriate-labour data-sharing arrangement agreed between the interior and labour ministries in August 2026 invokes Law No. 12 of 2010 and Law No. 24 of 2023 but establishes no legal basis for the exchange itself. Beneath all of it, the 1953 Code of Criminal Procedure remains the operative framework for police record-keeping, prescribing paper reports, sealed evidence pouches and monthly statistical returns carried physically to the Public Prosecution (2023). The clearest movement is on money: the Tripoli prime minister decreed in March 2026 that electronic payment is an approved method of collecting state revenues and public dues, requiring treasuries and public agencies to accept it.

Strategies, plans and policies

Libya replaced its national artificial-intelligence strategy eight months after publishing it: the National AI Strategy 2026–2030, launched by Prime Minister Abdulhamid Dbeibah on 1 June 2026 alongside a National AI Ethics Charter, supersedes the National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence 2025–2030 that the General Information Authority published in October 2025, prepared with UN-ESCWA and described as the state's highest reference strategy.

The paper estate is broader than anything standing behind it. A National Artificial Intelligence Policy published by the Ministry of Communications and Informatics in 2024 is the single instrument covering nine regulatory domains at once, from broadband and cybersecurity to digital identification, digital payments and e-commerce. The prime minister approved a National Strategy for Government Digital Transformation in April 2025 on four tracks — integrated digital government, a competitive digital economy, an inclusive digital society and a safe digital environment. The Central Bank of Libya launched a National Strategy for Financial Inclusion 2025-2029 in June 2025, whose consumer protection pillar proposes a dedicated unit and a supporting legal framework and whose electronic payment pillar commits to expanding government-to-person digital payments.

Delivery has no owner. Libya has a digital transformation strategy but no whole-of-government approach to public sector digital transformation, no ministry or department leading it, no cross-government forum for senior digital officials, and publishes nothing on progress or spending (2025); the entity responsible for data governance sits inside another institution rather than standing alone, and its data governance strategy is only planned or in progress. There is no government open source software policy or action plan for the public sector either. When the Ministry of Civil Service convened the General Information Authority, the Libyan Digital Company and its own IT office in Tripoli on 4 August 2026 to draw up a national digital transformation plan, no timetable, budget, lead agency or published document existed for it, and no body had been named as owning the unification of state databases it proposes.

The administration expected to deliver it scores 4.5 out of 100 for effective administration (2023), last of 54 African states, and 20.6 for public administration, 53rd of 54.

Regional collaboration

Libya scores 2.2 out of 100 for regional integration (2023), last of 54 African states and marginally lower than in 2014, despite membership of the Arab Maghreb Union, COMESA and the Community of Sahel-Saharan States.

What crosses the border is expertise rather than infrastructure. A Libyan biometrics firm won a commercial contract in June 2025 to modernise Niger's passport and national identity systems, while Libya's own credential is not accepted as a travel or identity document abroad. The Central Bank of Libya appears in the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System's published network coverage (June 2026). The most productive partnership has been with the UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia, which prepared the artificial-intelligence strategy with the General Information Authority.

Reach across Libya's own territory is the harder problem. The House of Representatives-appointed government's Ministry of Communications and Informatics granted a unified telecoms licence to OZON Aljaded For Telecom and Technology Group with effect from 4 March 2025, issuing it under Law No. 22 of 2010 — the same statute the Tripoli authority invokes as reserving all licensing to itself. That authority in turn cited ITU principles on respect for member states' sovereignty when it suspended Huawei's activities in August 2025.

Standards

The most openly documented technical rules in the Libyan state belong to a payment scheme: the Central Bank of Libya publishes LYPay's technical documentation, API specifications and regulatory compliance guidance on a public developer portal, putting the national instant payment scheme's rules in front of any prospective participant (2025).

Little else is written down that way. The government's interoperability framework exists only in draft or planned form and is not operational; there is no data quality framework, nothing monitoring the uptime of government information systems, and no guidance for replacing legacy systems (2025). The roadmap the General Information Authority published with UN-ESCWA in December 2025 proposes a four-phase build of a Libyan Government Interoperability Framework — preparation, design, implementation, sustainability — but remains a proposed action plan rather than an adopted framework with binding milestones. The National Guide for Government Data Governance requires government bodies to integrate through the National Data Exchange and adopts the Once-Only Principle, under which a citizen or business gives the state a piece of information once, and names cybersecurity-by-design a foundational pillar; the Authority applies it institution by institution rather than through any compliance regime.

Where shared standards would bite hardest, they are missing. The e-procurement portal is still under implementation and not operational, publishes no procurement data to the Open Contracting Data Standard, exchanges no data with other systems and has no governance arrangements covering registers, security or audit trails (2025). The national digital transformation work announced in August 2026 names no interoperability framework, standard or registry at all. The one mandatory regime in prospect is accessibility: the compliance standards to follow Libya's National Digital Accessibility Policy are to bind all public and private institutions providing digital services, and were still to come as at February 2026.

Data protection

Libya's only enforceable data protection rule is a central bank circular. The Personal Data Protection Regulation, Circular No. 18 of June 2025, bars banks, fintechs, payment providers and other supervised entities from storing personal, financial, credit or sensitive data outside Libya, carries fines of LYD 100,000 per violation and becomes mandatory on 1 July 2026 — the country's only data localisation requirement, and a sectoral one.

There is no standalone data protection law and no data protection authority: privacy provisions are scattered across Law No. 6 of 2022 on Electronic Transactions, Law No. 5 of 2022 on Combating Cybercrime, the 2011 Constitutional Declaration and Act No. 4 of 1990, while a national personal data protection law remains at committee-level drafting with the National Council for Public Freedoms and Human Rights (2024). Nothing monitors implementation or compliance, and nothing is published on complaints or enforcement (2025). Articles 73 to 79 of the electronic transactions law do set publicly available rules on the collection, processing, confidentiality and cross-border transfer of personal data by public entities and accredited authentication providers, including consent requirements and a right for individuals to access and update their data; no equivalent procedural rules have been published for the National ID Number database. No Libyan law requires anyone, payment service providers included, to notify users or any authority of a data breach within a set time (2024).

Enforcement is criminal rather than regulatory. The Interior Ministry handled 135 cybercrime cases in the first quarter of 2025, most of them concerning social media, and seized 188 devices in the same period. After the Attorney General's January 2026 findings on identity fraud inside the civil registry, procedures at the implicated offices were suspended and legal proceedings opened against the staff involved. The National AI Ethics Charter adopted on 1 June 2026 undertakes to safeguard individuals' digital rights and requires human decision-making to remain central to AI used in health, justice and security, with no statute behind it. Digital freedom scores 42.9 out of 100 (2023), 33rd of 54 African states and down 7.2 points since 2014.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

There is no channel through which the public enters digital policy. Libya has no national platform allowing citizens or businesses to take part in policy decision-making, no facility to submit petitions or give anonymous feedback, and no publication of any government response to such input (2025); there is likewise no platform for feedback on public service delivery, no published service standards such as response times or procedures, and no record of what government does with what it receives. Nor is there a right-to-information law requiring data or information to be made available to the public online, an entity monitoring compliance, or any statistics published on information requests received or granted (2025) — and public records are close to unobtainable in the first place (2023).

Rights is the fastest-deteriorating of Libya's sixteen governance sub-categories, down 7.2 points over 2014-2023 to 26.3 out of 100 and 47th of 54 African states, with media freedom at 38.2 and freedom of expression and belief at 28.1, the latter down 9.0 points over the decade.

The one participatory system that has been digitised is the electoral one. The High National Elections Commission has introduced biometric verification of voters in municipal council elections alongside the digital voter register it maintains (2024), though no comprehensive national registration drive has been run since 2021, only partial phased municipal registrations.

Inclusion

Digital divides

Price, not coverage, is the sharper edge of the divide: a mobile broadband data-only plan cost 3.6% of gross national income per capita in 2021, above the UN Broadband Commission's 2% affordability target, with the low-consumption data and voice basket at 2.3% and the high-consumption basket at 6.2%.

Headline access is not what keeps people out. Most Libyans were using the internet in 2024, 4G reached the large majority of the population in 2025, and the score for internet and computers is one of the country's most improved indicators of the past decade. What those national figures sit on top of is geography: infrastructure is concentrated in the cities, rural connectivity is limited and unreliable, and no rural data exchange or digital service programme is in place. In the south-west whole clusters of sites hang off single fibre routes with no terrestrial redundancy, so a flood in May 2026 cut them off and most were brought back over satellite backup rather than by repairing the cable.

Access to services

Payment access has had a second tier since March 2026: Central Bank of Libya Circular 9 of 2026 lets legally resident foreigners open an electronic wallet on a passport or residency document and a registered phone number, and the Bank of Commerce and Development opened the first without requiring a bank account, capped at LYD 50,000 a day to individuals and LYD 100,000 to companies. Citizens' ceilings are far higher, and nothing comparable reaches undocumented migrants, asylum seekers or stateless residents.

Underneath sits the National ID Number, reserved by law to Libyan citizens, leaving non-nationals, refugees and stateless residents on separate documents such as residence permits. It is a precondition for a bank account, a SIM card, the main social grants and a vote, and it is checked on paper rather than against the identity database in real time. Registering for the Social Security Fund's assistance and the Wife's and Children's Grant takes it alongside documents such as the family book, and not holding one turns away otherwise eligible people, migrants and refugees among them (2021). Libyans holding only a partial administrative number are outside the services gated on the national one, and protested in June 2025 against advisory recommendations that would leave that standing.

Almost none of it can be done at a distance: the online public service portal was informational only in 2025, with no transaction completable through it. Paying is its own gate: daily cash withdrawal limits were set nationwide from 9 August 2026, highest in the south, and clinics and medical centres are charging more for card payment than for cash, so a displayed price is effectively two prices.

A national digital accessibility policy adopted in April 2025 is in implementation planning by the General Information Authority with UN-ESCWA, whose mandatory standards, still to come, will bind all public and private providers of digital services and cover persons with disabilities and the elderly (February 2026). Expert assessment of how evenly public services reach different groups scored 37.8 out of 100 in 2023, 29th of 54 African states and down 1.8 over the decade.

Technology

AI

Libya has a domestic generative-AI system of its own: LIBIGPT went public in October 2025. In banking, Tadamon Bank is building an AI chatbot and interactive voice response service with an Indian vendor, still in development as at April 2026. That is close to the whole of what is running.

What is planned is much larger. Libya's current national AI strategy commits the Tripoli-based government to a National Data Exchange Platform by 2028, to automating half of government transactions and digitising 70% of paper records by 2030, and to AI models for detecting financial fraud and money laundering (June 2026). Those are dates to be met. Behind them sits the older National Artificial Intelligence Policy issued by the Ministry of Communications and Informatics in 2024, which remains the single published instrument covering artificial intelligence, broadband, cybersecurity, data centres and cloud services, data protection, digital identification, digital payments, digital signatures and e-commerce alike.

ICT Industry

The clearest sign of Libyan technology capability in the past year was an export: the biometrics firm Al Itissan Al-Jadeed won a commercial contract to modernise Niger's passport and national ID systems (June 2025). The same class of work at home runs on foreign suppliers, with HID Global selected for Libya's first e-passport programme, deployed from 2021 for diplomatic and special passports while the ordinary biometric passport for the general public stays pending. Nothing in state policy is pointed at building a domestic supplier base: as at 2025 Libya had no policy to support GovTech startups or private investment in them, gave no financing to startups or small and medium enterprises for innovation, operated no procurement priority or quota for their bids, and published nothing on the results of the support it does provide.

Innovation ecosystem

The working parts of Libya's innovation system are hubs rather than policy or money. Tatweer Research in Benghazi is an AfriLabs member hub running recurring programmes — the Enjazi competition, the Benghazi Hackathon and the TEC incubator — and in Tripoli the Ministry of Local Government, the EU and UNDP established the country's first municipality-led business incubator (2025). Around them the startup base is nascent, with no visible venture capital activity (2025).

Above that level there is very little. As at 2025 Libya had no national strategy on disruptive or innovative technologies and no state financing or procurement preference standing behind startups, and the government's own public-sector innovation function exists on paper with nothing published on what it has produced. Libya is absent from WIPO's Global Innovation Index, which profiles 133 economies (2024), so it carries no published innovation rank or score.

The new things that have actually reached Libyans came through the banks: Jumhouria Bank's petrol-station electronic payment service in January 2026 and the Central Bank's SoftPOS launch in June 2026.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The most recent American step into Libyan telecoms is a memorandum rather than a build: LPTIC, the state telecoms holding company, and the US engineering firm KBR signed one in January 2026 covering network and data-centre infrastructure.

The other American involvement is in energy, and it comes through aid: USAID supported the Renewable Energy Authority's National Strategy for Renewable Energy and Energy Efficiency 2023-2035, launched in December 2023 alongside a "Go Green" initiative targeting 500MW of distributed rooftop photovoltaic capacity across residential, public, agricultural and industrial buildings.

China activities

Huawei's position in Libya turns on a licensing question rather than a political one. On 17 August 2025 the Government of National Unity's General Authority for Telecommunications and Informatics suspended all Huawei activities in Libya with immediate effect, citing entry into contracts with illegitimate entities, breach of Law No. 22 of 2010 and violation of ITU principles on respect for member states' sovereignty, and declaring null and void any contract concluded outside GTI-approved frameworks. Three days later the authority announced an agreement with Huawei Technizon Technical Services – Libya Branch allowing its activities to continue after the company undertook full compliance with Law No. 22 of 2010, and that is the licensing basis Huawei has operated under since. The same account records that Huawei has been present in Libya for more than twenty years and contributed to 3G and 4G rollout with local operators — a footprint deep enough that the suspension read as a claim over who licenses the company rather than a move to remove it.

Chinese vendors reach the state directly and at the centre of it. In July 2026 the Ministry of Civil Service was scoping implementation of its digital transformation plan with Huawei Libya, and in March 2026 ZTE and the GNU-side state operator Libya Telecom & Technology signed a memorandum of understanding on 4G and 5G at MWC Barcelona. Chinese hardware also sat behind the country's one attempt at a domestic private-cloud facility: the 2019 announcement by Trans-Sahara and the publicly owned Tatweer Research specified a Huawei containerised data centre for Tripoli, to serve government agencies and local companies.

EU activities

Europe's footprint is the one that lands physically. The Medusa submarine cable, an 8,700 km system touching Italy, Spain, Portugal, Morocco, Tunisia, Greece, Egypt and Cyprus, was inaugurated at Misrata in May 2025, giving Libya a direct link into the European network; the capacity was contracted in 2023 through the Libya International Telecom Company, and further landings at Tripoli and Benghazi were still only planned when Misrata opened. European equipment vendors remain at the discussion stage, LPTIC meeting Nokia in July 2026 over accelerating 5G as one of the several foreign partners the holding company keeps in parallel.

Everything else European runs through projects rather than contracts. France has funded two consecutive digital-skills programmes, Raqameyon continuing and building on the earlier Raqam-e, both implemented by Expertise France, the second running from March 2023 to April 2024 and covering public- and private-sector employees, women, entrepreneurs and the Ministry of Education. The EU otherwise works through UN agencies and ministries: with UNDP and the Ministry of Local Government it established Libya's first municipality-led business incubator in Tripoli (2025), and the Ministry of Education's Education Management Information System was developed with UNICEF and EU support to collect school- and student-level statistics, a sector-internal system whose learner records go into no government-wide exchange. EU money also sits behind the prototype online registration tool that is the only digital part of a Commercial Registry otherwise run manually and in person, from Tripoli and Benghazi separately.

India activities

India's presence in Libya is in skills and banking software rather than infrastructure. Libya and India announced cooperation to qualify Libyan national cadres in quantum computing and artificial intelligence in February 2026. Separately, Tadamon Bank has engaged the Indian vendor JMR Infotech to build an AI chatbot and interactive voice response service for its customers (April 2026).

Gulf/UAE activities

The Gulf's entry into Libyan digital finance is on the eastern side of the country's institutional split: Network International of the UAE is building a digital payments and card platform for Seraj Islamic Bank, a Benghazi-based bank established in 2024, as at April 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Libya publishes no measure of basic digital literacy at all: the ITU's Digital Development Dashboard records the country's ICT skills indicators as not available, on data running to December 2022. Nothing on the policy side is filling that in either, with no government digital skills programmes for citizens or for schools (2025).

The schooling underneath it is weak and has been getting weaker. Libya's education score was 42.6 out of 100 in 2023, 41st of 54 African states and down 4.1 points over the preceding decade, a decline driven by equality of access rather than by quality, which held flat at a low level. That score also rests on a partial set of indicators, several of them carrying no value for Libya, and what the country does publish openly on education outcomes and school facilities sits near the bottom of the Open Data Inventory (2024). Libya reports neither enrolment nor completion into the international series that would let anyone check.

The instrument that would answer it exists. The Ministry of Education runs an education management information system, built with UNICEF and EU support, collecting school- and student-level statistics (2025), but it stays inside the sector and its learner records go into no government-wide exchange. The same ministry is a partner in the French-funded Raqameyon programme, which set out to put a digital training platform into a handful of schools and to train a small number of teachers and ministry staff to deliver it (2023). That is a pilot, and it is the extent of the digital literacy effort reaching Libyan classrooms.

Training and skills

The Tripoli administration's Ministry of Planning launched an institute offering a professional master's programme in artificial intelligence and cybersecurity, run with UNDP and tied to the Libya Vision 2050 process (November 2025). It arrives on top of an administration with no strategy or programme of its own to raise digital skills in the public sector (2025), which is the gap it is meant to close and cannot close alone.

Training keeps its place in Libyan technology policy across a change of strategy. The National Strategy for AI 2025–2030 covered data-science and AI training alongside ethical-AI legislation and deployment in health, education and energy (October 2025), and the successor strategy Dbaiba's government adopted in June 2026 commits to training staff in advanced technology fields and to seeding a cohort of AI startups. Neither names a delivery institution or a budget. Alongside them sits an agreed cooperation with India on qualifying Libyan national cadres in quantum computing and artificial intelligence (February 2026), announced without a start date.

What has actually been delivered is smaller and older. France funded Raqameyon, a national digital-skills programme run by Expertise France whose window closed in 2024, and it was the second consecutive French-funded digital-skills project in the country, built on the lessons of an earlier one, Raqam-e. Its design aimed at public- and private-sector employees, entrepreneurs and small businesses, and women, teaching basic office software rather than the advanced fields the strategies name. Outside government entirely, hub-based programmes in Benghazi run recurring competitions, hackathons and incubation (2025), a continuing skills route in the east of the country with no administration behind it.

Research institutions

Knowledge production in Libya is being rebuilt from the statistical office outwards rather than from the universities in. UNDP and the General Information Authority signed a memorandum in July 2025 to strengthen national data systems, with the 7th National Human Development Report as the immediate focus — a state body producing an analytical output, with external support.

Universities enter chiefly as recipients. Libya's AI strategy of October 2025 named university research and development among its priorities, and the postgraduate institute the Ministry of Planning launched with UNDP is a teaching route rather than a research programme. Whether Libyan institutions produce knowledge the state then uses was not established as at August 2026.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Libya runs no rural data exchange and no rural digital service programme, and its digital infrastructure sits in the cities (2025). What capture there is outside them comes from one sector platform and one register: MerWat-Libya, live since March 2024, lets the agriculture and water ministries and the Libyan Centre for Remote Sensing share land and water use data, without forming part of the national data exchange, and the civil registration authority's service offices reach rural areas and work to a single automated central database (2024). Everywhere else the record is on paper: rural primary schools keep student, attendance and staff records at the facility, and medical records in primary healthcare clinics remain paper-based, with health management information systems not in routine use at either national or local level (2024).

The blank runs into the measurement as well. All four rural-economy indicators in the 2024 Ibrahim Index — rural land and water access, market access, economy support, and representation and participation — are unmeasured for Libya in 2023, leaving the rural economy the only one of the index's sixteen sub-categories with no score at all.

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Libya's digital estate is administered nationally only: the parallel administrations make sub-national coordination especially difficult, and LY-GOVREP, the platform on which government entities are represented, covers central government alone (2025). The country's first municipality-led business incubator opened in Tripoli in 2025, set up by the EU and UNDP with the Ministry of Local Government.

What does reach below the capital is national by construction, such as the postal authority's digital addressing system, live nationwide (2026). Inside the state, the Ministry of Interior's adoption of e-management systems was at an early stage in 2023, held back by weak infrastructure and a shortage of specialised staff, and its digital transformation pilots — a smart surveillance camera trial and a single EU- and UNDP-funded model police station — are in Tripoli. Digital systems for local administration are among the things the national digital transformation plan under preparation is meant to deliver, alongside unified databases and integration between state institutions (August 2026).

Data

National statistics

The capacity of Libya's statistical system scored 15.2 out of 100 in 2023 and ranked last of 54 African states, having fallen 20.2 points since 2014 — the third most deteriorated of the 96 indicators the Ibrahim Index measures for the country. Of the five survey types the World Bank tracks, only a labour survey had been run in the previous ten years, with no household, health, agricultural or business survey in that period as at 2023; a population census falls inside the last twenty years, but no agricultural or business census does. The weakest of the five pillars is data sources, scoring under 20 per cent in 2023, while data services and data products both sit in the 50 to 69 per cent band — the machinery for publishing outruns the material there is to publish.

The effect shows up as blanks in other people's numbers. Libya is unscored on 22 of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators for 2023, including education enrolment, education completion and human resources in education, three of the six education indicators, and none of the index's public perception measures are scored at all. The country is absent altogether from WIPO's Global Innovation Index for 2024, the ITU records its ICT skills indicators as not available, and public financial management runs without any unified budget classification or chart of accounts as at 2025.

Rebuilding that capacity is under way, mostly one sector at a time. The Civil Registry Authority's electronic records have been matched against its paper files across the country's registry offices, an exercise not attempted since the 1970s (September 2024). The Ministry of Education runs an education management information system built with UNICEF and EU support, though it serves the sector alone and rural primary schools still keep student, attendance and staff records on paper; health reporting runs on a WHO-supported DHIS2 installation on the same terms as at 2026. UNDP and Libya's General Information Authority signed a memorandum of understanding in July 2025 to strengthen national data systems, with the seventh National Human Development Report as the immediate focus.

Open data

Libya acquired an open data portal on 27 November 2025, when the General Information Authority launched an Open Government Data Platform; by February 2026 it carried 91 datasets from nine government entities across eight sectors, with a technical standards guide and an intended connection to the National Data Distributor. Nine publishing bodies is the measure of how far it reaches into government, and the open-data policy that accompanies it remained in draft as at February 2026.

It arrived into a near-total absence. The World Bank's 2025 GovTech assessment recorded no open data portal and no right-to-information law requiring information to be made available online, no body monitoring compliance and no statistics published on requests received or granted. Public records themselves are close to unobtainable: accessibility scored 3.0 out of 100 in 2023, 53rd of 54 African states, with disclosure of public records at 12.5, the latter down 12.5 points over the decade and among Libya's ten most deteriorated indicators. Open Data Watch's inventory for 2024 found nothing published openly at all on agriculture, pollution, crime and violence, or poverty and income and no category scoring above 4.5 out of 10, reproductive health being the best of them; education outcomes score 2 and education facilities zero.

The Libyan state publishes no results, spending or performance information on any of the sixteen areas the GovTech Maturity Index tests for transparency in 2025, from cloud services and interoperability to data protection, the right to information, digital skills, startup support, the public service portal and citizen participation.

The exception is the payment rail, where the Central Bank of Libya publishes LYPay's technical documentation, API specifications and regulatory compliance guidance on a public developer portal open to any prospective participant — more than any other Libyan public body publishes about how its systems work. Procurement is the opposite case: the e-procurement portal is still under implementation, with no procurement data published to the Open Contracting Data Standard as at 2025.

Use of satellite data

Earth observation in Libya is used at sector level and not much beyond it. The FAO and AICS-funded MerWat-Libya geospatial platform, launched in March 2024, lets the Ministries of Agriculture and Water Resources and the Libyan Centre for Remote Sensing share land and water use data, but it stands outside the national data exchange. Land administration has had no such refresh: UN-Habitat's 2024 assessment finds the cadastre still resting on incomplete aerial photogrammetry with no modern GIS or spatial database behind it, survey work having been suspended after 2011.

Finance

New investments

External finance for Libya's digital development runs to a single commitment, a French-funded skills project of 2023 to 2024.

That commitment is Raqameyon, a national digital-skills programme funded by France and implemented by Expertise France from March 2023 to April 2024, worth less than a million euros and aimed at public- and private-sector employees, women, entrepreneurs and the Ministry of Education. It is the second consecutive French project of its kind, following Expertise France's earlier Raqam-e.

What movement there is elsewhere is domestic or vendor-led rather than donor-funded. The Central Bank of Libya used EPAIX 2026 in June to launch international Visa acceptance through local point-of-sale terminals and a national stand-in processing service meant to keep payments running through communications or banking disruption, and in the east the UAE's Network International is building a payments and card stack for a Benghazi bank founded in 2024 (April 2026).

MoUs and other agreements

ZTE and the Tripoli-side state operator Libya Telecom & Technology signed a memorandum of understanding at MWC Barcelona in March 2026 covering 4G and 5G planning and deployment, a digital-service ecosystem spanning e-wallet, e-commerce and content delivery, and consumer terminals — and it binds neither side, with no value and no timetable published. It is also an agreement with one of the two administrations, not with the country.

LPTIC signed a comparable memorandum with the US engineering firm KBR in January 2026 covering infrastructure, data centres, cybersecurity and 5G networks, again with no value, no timetable and no work announced under it. The state holding company takes several foreign partners rather than one, and met Nokia in July 2026 about accelerating 5G without an agreement following.

Not all of it is telecoms: UNDP and the General Information Authority signed a memorandum in July 2025 to strengthen national data systems.

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